will want to make a point and will pull a specific combination of data to prove their perspective. The problem that can stem from pulling only part of the whole data set is that they'll pull only the data they need to prove a point, which can lead to uninformed and usually poor decisions.

If you want to use data to effect change, you should find a metric that matters to the people you're trying to convince, but always keep an open mind; your assumptions may be incorrect. Data can be misleading when used in a superficial fashion; that is, a single metric doesn't tell the whole story. When you're working to prove or disprove a hypothesis, be sure to have different data points that check each other.

Take, for example, a team that's developing features for a mobile app that has a two-month development cycle for each feature, the second half of which is purely dedicated to hardening the codebase and cleaning up tech debt. If you look at some data for this team, you could see trends like those shown in figure 9.13.

Figure 9.13. The trends for a team that spent one month on development and one month on hardening

